How Buddhism Became Chinese_For Further Study

The topics covered in these lectures appear only cursorily, if at all, in general studies, so here I have suggested some supplementary readings for those interested in delving more deeply. Some of the works cited are scholarly studies, but they are written for educated nonspecialists as well and can be read profitably by them.

Lecture One: Beyond the Hindu Kush: Alexander, the Silk Road, and the Hellenized States of Central Asia

Green, Peter, *Alexander of Macedon, 356–323 B.C.: A Historical Biography.* Berkeley, 1991.

Stoneman, Richard, *The Greek Experience of India: From Alexander to the Indo-Greeks*. Princeton, 2019

Kubica, Olga, *Greco-Buddhist Relations in the Hellenistic Far East: Sources and Contexts*. New York, 2023.

Salomon, Richard, *The Buddhist Literature of Ancient Gandhāra: An Introduction with Selected Translations*. Somerville, MA, 2018.

Heim, Maria, trans., *The Questions of Milinda*. Cambridge, 2025.

Lecture Two: Harmonizing the Three Teachings

Ch'en, Kenneth K.S., *Buddhism in China, A Historical Survey*. Princeton, 1964.

Ch'en, Kenneth K.S., *The Chinese Transformation of Buddhism*. Princeton 1973.

Yü, Chün-fang. *Chinese Buddhism, A Thematic History*. Honolulu, 2020.

deBary, Wm Theodore and Irene Bloom, comps., *Sources of Chinese Tradition,* Volume 1: *From Earliest Times to 1600,* Second Edition. New York, 1999.

Wright, Arthur F., *Buddhism in Chinese History.* Stanford, 1959.

Lecture Three: Untangling the Knot

Gregory, Peter N., *Tsung-mi and the Sinification of Buddhism*. Princeton, 1991.

Lecture Four: Church and State

Weinstein, Stanley, *Buddhism under the T'ang*. Cambridge, 1987.

Lecture Five: Ways to Emancipation

Gregory, Peter N., ed., *Sudden and Gradual: Approaches to Enlightenment in Chinese Thought*. Honolulu, 1987.

McRae, John R., *The Northern School and the Formation of Early Ch'an Buddhism*. Honolulu, 1986.

McRae, John R., *Zen Evangelist: Shenhui, Sudden Enlightenment, and the Southern School of Chan Buddhism*. Honolulu, 2023.

Lecture Six: The Latter Days of the Law

Nattier, Jan, *Once Upon a Future Time: Studies in a Buddhist Prophecy of Decline*. Fremont, CA, 1991.